

Contract-to-Capacity Workshop

Before a deal is signed, we know whether we can staff it. If we cannot, a named person owns the gap.

Tuesday 6 October

08:30	Arrival
09:00	Welcome and how the two days work
09:30	Ground in reality
10:45	Break
11:00	Agree the target outcome
12:30	Lunch · build starts
13:15	Define how it should work: decisions and evidence
14:45	Break
15:00	Define how it should work: rules and exceptions
16:15	Build checkpoint
16:45	Close of Day 1

Wednesday 7 October

08:30	Arrival
09:00	Recap and build status
09:15	Test the Proof of Concept
10:30	Break · fix list to the build team
10:45	Resolve key boundaries
11:45	Skill rotation rules, with the markets
13:00	Lunch · build applies fixes
13:45	Shape what happens next
15:00	Break · build freeze
15:15	Review the live Proof of Concept
16:15	Close: make the decision

Three answers the system can give

✓ Go ahead

Nothing is broken. The system acts.

👤 Ask a person

A named person decides, within a set time.

🛑 Stop

A rule is broken. Refused, with the rule shown.

How we work together

✍ Correct the draft

Everything starts from a draft. Fix it, don't start over.

🗳 Decide, don't wait for everyone

Every session ends with a decision, an owner and a date.

💬 Plain words

Anyone can say: stop, explain that.

🔍 Finding problems is the job

A test that finds nothing is not good enough.

The words we use

Contract-to-Capacity

Turning a deal we are likely to win into a staffing plan, checking who is really free, and giving every unfilled role an owner.

Engine

A system that runs one kind of work from start to a checked finish. It drafts, follows agreed rules, and sends the hard calls to named people.

Proof of Concept

A first working version, built during these two days, to test the idea on real cases.

Proceed, Narrow or Stop

The three possible decisions at the end of Day 2. Proceed: go ahead as planned. Narrow: go ahead with a smaller scope. Stop: not now, and we say why.

Record

What a system says, such as Workday or Atlas.

Shortfall

Nobody found yet. Not a gap until someone has checked.

Gap

A confirmed shortage, with its evidence, declared by a named person, and owned.

Outcome

The result we promise for every deal. True or false for one deal, and provable from a record.

Done checks

The checks that prove a deal's case is finished, read from a record we trust.

Hold

Held: a person is reserved for this deal, for a limited time. The hold ends on its own unless someone renews it.

Decision owner

The role that makes a decision, with a backup and a response time. A role, not a team.

Evidence

The facts a decision owner needs, and the system or person each one comes from.

Rule

When this happens, then this, decided by this role, by this time. If nobody answers, it goes to this role.

Top of license

Working at the highest level you are qualified for.

Chain of moves

A new job is filled by someone stepping up, others step up behind them, and a junior hire or a free person fills the last job.

Pilot

The first real use of the new way of working, on a small part of the business, to learn safely before going wider.

First slice

The part of the business the pilot starts with: which practice, country, deals and decisions.

Baseline

How the work performs today, measured, so we can show any improvement.

Eight steps over the two days

1	Why we are here I know why we are here and what we decide at the end.
2	The real problem I see where records and reality part, at each stage of a deal.
3	The result we want I can say the result we want, and how a record would prove it.
4	Who decides I know which decisions need a person, who, and what they need to see.
5	When things go wrong I can write the rule for an exception: what happens, who decides, by when.
6	Judge a working version I can test a working version and say what it got wrong.
7	Rules for moves I can set the rules for moving people up to the work they are qualified for.
8	Decide what next I can weigh the evidence and decide what to take forward.

BRING ONE CASE · ABOUT FIVE MINUTES

One recent staffing case

The work, in one line (no client names needed)

The roles it needed

Where did it get stuck? Tick one stage

- ☐ 1 Demand emerges ☐ 2 Work becomes a staffing need ☐ 3 Staffing sees the request
☐ 4 Who could do it, and who is free ☐ 5 Can they actually start ☐ 6 Is there a real gap
☐ 7 The gap goes to action

What happened in the end

One thing that would have helped

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NO PHONE? ANSWER HERE

Two quick questions

How comfortable are you using AI tools at work today?

1 2 3 4 5

Never used them

Every day

In five words or fewer: where did your last deal get stuck?

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✂ Cut along the dashed lines.

A

Hold up your answer

B

Hold up your answer

C

Hold up your answer

D

Hold up your answer